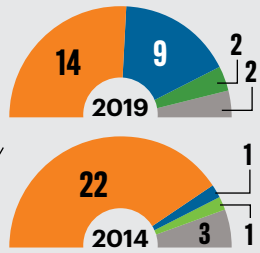
GT ROAD BELT

Total seats: 27

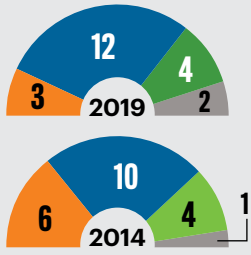


BIG FACTORS

- Dominated by non-Jats, this urbanised belt along GT Road is the BJP's oldest core but is seeing anti-incumbency
- The RSS cadre is the most active in this belt; the BJP has reverted to old-timers like Anil Vij to blunt the anger against former CM Manohar Lal Khattar
- The Congress has fielded the maximum non-Jat candidates here to cut into the BJP's vote share

DESHWAL REGION

Total seats: 21

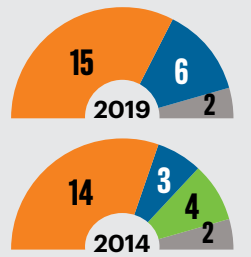


BIG FACTORS

- Dominated by Deshwali Jats, this is Bhupinder Singh Hooda's bastion, but many Congress MLAs are facing anti-incumbency
- The depleted Jat support for the Chautalas (INLD and JJP) could work in the Congress's favour
- Facing Jat anger, the BJP hopes to consolidate support among non-Jats, Punjabis and Brahmins

AHIRWAL-MEWAT BELT

Total seats: 23



BIG FACTORS

- Lot of anger against the erstwhile Khattar regime owing to lack of employment generation and urban development in the region
- With the Congress reposing faith in MLA Mamman Khan, an accused in the 2023 Nuh riots, Hindutva factor could come into play
- The BJP hopes to corner Ahir-Yadav vote by fielding Union minister Rao Inderjit Singh's daughter Arti Rao

virtual collapse of the regional powerhouses—the Abhay Chautala-led Indian National Lok Dal (INLD) and his nephew Dushyant Chautala's Jannayak Janta Party (JJP)—their support base has largely been split between the Congress and the BJP. On an upswing, the former got a larger piece of the pie—primarily Jat, but also a sprinkling of OBCs and Dalits (see *The Caste Factor*). To reverse some of that latter flow, a couple of 'Dalit party' alliances have been floated. Mayawati's Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) is with the INLD, while Bhim Army chief Chandrashekhar's Aazad Samaj Party (ASP) has chosen to debut in Haryana as a partner of the JJP. Any votes snapped up by them will be a loss to the Congress, so they have also attracted the old 'B-team' critique.

To win back the Dalits on its own steam, the BJP's state unit has also been running a door-to-door outreach campaign since July. To sweeten the deal, it has promised various freebies for the poor, including full scholarship to OBC/ SC students studying medicine and engineering in any government college in India. The Congress, too, has countered with seven

THE FREEBIE FLURRY

How the BJP's promises stack up against the Congress's guarantees

BJP

- ₹2,100 per month to all women; LPG cylinder for ₹500
- Free ₹10 lakh health cover for each family; additional ₹5 lakh for each elderly (70+)
- Free dialysis in govt hospitals, diagnosis in all hospitals
- Guaranteed government jobs to 200,000 youths and Agniveers from Haryana
- 500,000 houses for the poor in urban and rural areas
- Scooter for every college-going student in rural areas
- Welfare boards for 36 small backward communities
- Full scholarship to OBC/ SC students studying medicine and engineering in any government college in India

CONGRESS

- ₹2,000 per month to every woman (18-60 years), LPG cylinder for ₹500
- ₹6,000 monthly pension to the elderly, disabled and widows; reinstating the OPS
- 300 units of free electricity, free medical cover up to ₹25 lakh for each household
- 100 yards plot and two-room house at a cost of ₹3.5 lakh for the poor
- 200,000 regular jobs
- Legal guarantee on MSP
- Caste survey; increase in OBC creamy layer to ₹10 lakh